Activity Helmets

The Scouts have introduced changes in POR regarding use of helmets. Please have a read of the attached link for more information, which also links to the new POR rules for Climbing and Abseiling. See FS120430 for more information.

Hazards and Risks - Helmets

Following these changes, the risk assessment regarding helmet use at the campsite will be updated. The helmet signage will remain in place. This is most likely to affect regular/repeat groups, or team use of the wall outside of sessions. If in doubt, use helmets.

Equipment falling from the Tower

- All equipment should be secured when above ground - either attached to someone's harness or the Tower itself. No equipment is to be placed loose on the deck.
- The climbing walls extend above the top deck which further reduces the likelihood of anything being kicked or dropped on the climbing sides.
- Adjustments to the setup of climbs must not take place when the climbs are in use. Stop climbing and make sure everyone is well back.
- When abseiling is being run, it is still possible for the instructor to drop equipment as they are connecting it to the rope. **Helmets must be worn by anyone beneath an active abseil (including abseilers).**
- When completing maintenance on the Tower it is more likely for things to be dropped. As much as possible, equipment must be secured to the rope or harness to prevent this. People on the ground should keep well clear of anyone who may drop something from height. **Helmets must be worn when there is any chance someone will drop a *hold* or *tool* during maintenance.**

Bumps to the head

- The Petzl Panga helmets we use are designed to protect from top impacts. They have limited protection against side, front or back impacts.
- The Petzl Picchu helmets we have provide better side, front and back protection.
- Climbers may bump their head on the large holds on the climbing wall. This is more likely with novice climbers, who often need the larger holds to climb. Helmets may reduce the impact of any bump.
- Novice climbers may fall awkwardly from the wall, including turning around or curling up, exposing the back, sides or top of their head to the wall. Good advice and coaching will help with avoiding this, as will practicing descent and falling. Helmets may reduce the impact of any bump.
- A top-heavy climber, or one with little-to-no core strength, wearing a sit harness is more likely to turn upside down when they fall. Any such people should wear a full-body harness, or a chest harness with a sit harness.
- Anyone heading in/out/up the inside of the Tower, or moving on the top deck of the Tower, is more likely to bump their head on something. Helmets are required for any novices inside the Tower and recommended for everyone else.
- Someone could bump their head on the long diagonal poles supporting the Tower. They have been painted bright yellow so that they stand out. Good briefing and group management should keep all people away from these poles.